WebScheduler Local

INTERNAL GUIDE

How the Partner Program works.

The rules, the money and the edge cases, worked through one example: Partner A, who brings us Customer A and Customer B.

01 **THE MODEL**
Five steps from application to payout.

02 **THE RULES**
What gets credited, what earns, and what never does.

03 **THE WORKED EXAMPLE**
Partner A, Customer A and Customer B, month by month.

04 **WHAT IF**
Every edge case, and what the system does with it.

05 **BEFORE LAUNCH**
The decisions this example makes plain.

WebScheduler (Pty) Ltd · October 2026 · Written against the code on the feature/partner-program branch, not yet live.
Partner A, Customer A and Customer B are invented examples.

01 · THE MODEL

Partners bring businesses. We share what they pay.

A partner is anyone who works with South African businesses: a web or marketing agency, a bookkeeper, a business coach, a community group, or a business already on WebScheduler Local. They share a personal link. When a business they send us pays for Verified Business or an International Profile, they earn 20% of each payment for that business's first 12 months. Free profiles stay free, so they earn nothing.

01 **APPLY**

At /partners. They tell us who they work with and how they will share the link, and accept the Partner Program terms.

02 **WE APPROVE**

At /admin/partners. Approval emails them their link, local.webscheduler.co.za/p/their-code, and a sign in link to their dashboard. Declined applicants get a polite no.

03 **THEY SHARE THE LINK**

Opening it sets a cookie for 60 days. Adding ?ref=their-code to any page on the site does the same.

04 **A BUSINESS SIGNS UP**

A new business profile created on that browser in those 60 days is credited to the partner.

05 **THE BUSINESS PAYS, THE PARTNER EARNS**

Each cleared payment earns 20%, held 30 days, then paid by EFT once a month when the partner is owed R500.00 or more.

Separate from Recommend a business (/recommend), which is a visitor's tip with no link and no money. Both run side by side.

02 · THE RULES

Credited once.
Earning for 12 payments.

When a business is credited to a partner

ALL OF THESE MUST HOLD	WHY
The partner is approved	An applicant's or a suspended partner's link sets no cookie.
The link was opened in the last 60 days, on the same browser	The cookie lives on the device. A phone click and a laptop signup do not connect.
The profile is new: created in the last hour	Someone typing in an email we already know gets their existing profile back, and that business was not brought in by today's click.
The profile has no partner yet	The first credit stands. It is never moved by a later click.
The owner's email is not the partner's	A partner cannot refer their own business.

When a payment earns commission

ALL OF THESE MUST HOLD	WHY
Paystack reports it paid	Cancellations and failed payments earn nothing.
The partner is approved at the time	A suspended partner stops earning. What they already earned is still theirs.
It was paid after the profile was credited	Crediting a profile by hand never pays out for the past.
It is one of the first 12 monthly payments	Counted from the subscription's first payment, so the 13th never earns.
It has not earned before	One commission per payment id, enforced by the database, so a repeated notification cannot pay twice.

The amount is the payment times the partner's rate: 20% by default, or a rate we set for that partner. The rate is stored on each commission, so changing it later only affects payments from then on.

03 · THE WORKED EXAMPLE

One partner, two customers. Two different paths.

WHO	IN THIS EXAMPLE (INVENTED)
Partner A	Lindiwe, who runs Sizwe Digital, a small web agency in Durban. Approved on 28 October 2026. Her link is local.webscheduler.co.za/p/sizwe-digital.
Customer A	Thabo's Plumbing. Signs up straight away and goes Verified.
Customer B	Northside Dental. Takes its time, starts free, goes Verified later and cancels after four months.

CUSTOMER A · THABO'S PLUMBING

DATE	WHAT HAPPENS, AND WHAT THE SYSTEM DOES
1 Nov 2026	Lindiwe sends Thabo her link on WhatsApp. WhatsApp fetches it for the preview: **not counted**, it is not a person. Thabo taps it on his phone: **one click counted**, cookie set until 31 December.
1 Nov 2026	Thabo creates his business profile on the same phone. The profile is new, has no partner, and is not Lindiwe's own: **credited to Partner A**.
4 Nov 2026	He sends his documents for Verified Business. We approve them.
5 Nov 2026	First payment, R29.99. Partner A earns **R6.00**, held until 5 December. The 12 month window starts today.
5th of each month	Each renewal earns another R6.00, each held 30 days.
5 Oct 2027	The 12th payment. The last one that earns.
5 Nov 2027	The 13th payment. Thabo is still Verified and we keep his payment, but **Partner A earns nothing more** from Customer A.

Customer A in total: 12 payments of R29.99 = R359.88 to us, R72.00 of it to Partner A.

03 · THE WORKED EXAMPLE

Customer B takes the long way. It still counts.

CUSTOMER B · NORTHSIDE DENTAL

DATE	WHAT HAPPENS, AND WHAT THE SYSTEM DOES
10 Nov 2026	Lindiwe emails the practice manager her link. She opens it on her work laptop: **one click counted**, cookie set until 9 January. She does not sign up yet.
20 Dec 2026	Forty days later she types our address straight into the same laptop and creates a free business profile. The cookie is still there: **credited to Partner A**, even though this visit did not come from the link.
Dec to Feb	A free profile. Nobody pays, so **nothing is earned**.
15 Feb 2027	Northside goes Verified. First payment, R29.99: Partner A earns **R6.00**. Their 12 month window starts today, not in December: it runs from the first payment, not the signup.
Mar to May	Three renewals, R6.00 each.
20 May 2027	Northside cancels. The badge stays until 15 June, the date already paid for, then lapses. No more payments, so **no more commission**. What Partner A earned stays hers.

Customer B in total: 4 payments of R29.99 = R119.96 to us, R24.00 of it to Partner A. If Northside came back as Verified in 2028, those payments would be past its 12 month window and would earn nothing.

IF THE TIMING HAD BEEN DIFFERENT

- Signing up on 15 January, 66 days after the click: the 60 day cookie has expired, so the profile is **not credited**. We can credit it by hand at /admin/partners if Lindiwe shows us the referral; only payments after that would earn.
- Signing up on her phone instead of the laptop: no cookie on that phone, so **not credited** automatically. Same fix by hand.
- Opening another partner's link before signing up: the **newer link wins** and that partner is credited. Once credited, a profile never moves.

03 · THE WORKED EXAMPLE

Year one: R96.00. Month by month.

What Partner A earns, by the month the payment was made. Each amount is held 30 days before it can be paid, so November's commission becomes payable in December, and so on.

MONTH	CUSTOMER A	CUSTOMER B	EARNED	RUNNING TOTAL
Nov 2026	R6.00		R6.00	R6.00
Dec 2026	R6.00		R6.00	R12.00
Jan 2027	R6.00		R6.00	R18.00
Feb 2027	R6.00	R6.00	R12.00	R30.00
Mar 2027	R6.00	R6.00	R12.00	R42.00
Apr 2027	R6.00	R6.00	R12.00	R54.00
May 2027	R6.00	R6.00	R12.00	R66.00
Jun 2027	R6.00		R6.00	R72.00
Jul 2027	R6.00		R6.00	R78.00
Aug 2027	R6.00		R6.00	R84.00
Sep 2027	R6.00		R6.00	R90.00
Oct 2027	R6.00		R6.00	R96.00
Year one	**R72.00**	**R24.00**	**R96.00**	

WHERE THE MONEY GOES, YEAR ONE	AMOUNT	SHARE
Customers A and B pay us (16 payments)	R479.84	100%
Partner A's commission	R96.00	20%
We keep, before payment fees	R383.84	80%

20% of R29.99 is R5.998, which rounds to R6.00. Commission is worked out on what Paystack reports as paid, so a price change shows up automatically.

Today's settings never pay her. That is the finding.

We pay a partner once they are owed R500.00 or more. Partner A earns R96.00 in a full year from two customers, so **she never reaches the minimum**. Her balance waits on her dashboard as Ready to pay, and nothing goes to her bank.

At 20% and R500.00, a partner needs 7 businesses paying every month for a whole year before we pay them once.

Software affiliate programs like Elementor's pay a share of a purchase worth hundreds of dollars. Ours is a small monthly price, so the same percentage is a much smaller amount, and it takes many customers to add up.

RATE	PER PAYMENT	PARTNER A, YEAR ONE	ONE CUSTOMER, 12 MONTHS	TO REACH R500.00 IN A YEAR
20%	R6.00	R96.00	R72.00	7 businesses
30%	R9.00	R144.00	R108.00	5 businesses
40%	R12.00	R192.00	R144.00	4 businesses

WHEN A PARTNER DOES REACH THE MINIMUM

01 **THE SWEEP**

Every night at 03:50, commission whose 30 day hold has ended moves from Held to Ready to pay.

02 **THE PAYOUT LIST**

/admin/partners/payouts lists everyone owed R500.00 or more, with the bank account they saved.

03 **WE PAY, THEN RECORD IT**

Pay by EFT from the bank first. Then enter the EFT reference and press Mark paid: every Ready commission becomes Paid, and the partner is emailed a statement.

04 · WHAT IF

Every edge case. And what happens.

IF	THEN
Customer A already had a profile and signs up again with the same email	They get a link to their existing profile. It is older than an hour, so it is not credited.
Lindiwe signs up her own agency through her own link	Same email as hers: not credited. A different email would get through the check, so we look out for it and can remove the credit.
A customer's payment is refunded within the 30 day hold	We cancel that commission at /admin/partners. It is never paid.
A refund comes after the partner was already paid	A paid commission cannot be cancelled. We take it up with the partner directly.
Paystack sends the same payment notification twice	The second is ignored, for the payment and for the commission.
Recording a commission fails (database trouble)	The customer's payment still goes through. The nightly sweep rebuilds any commission missed in the last 7 days.
We suspend Partner A in March	Her link stops tracking and her customers' payments stop earning. What she earned before is still hers. Reinstating her does not pay for the months in between.
We change Partner A's rate to 30%	Payments from that moment earn 30%. Earlier commission keeps the rate it was worked out at.
A credited business is based abroad and pays for an International Profile	Those payments earn the same way: 12 payments, counted from its first International payment.
Customer A deletes their profile	No more payments, so no more commission. Earned commission stays.
A partner never adds bank details	They appear on the payout list, marked, with no Mark paid button until they do.
A declined applicant	Their application is deleted 12 months after we decide, as the privacy policy promises.

WHAT EACH PERSON SEES

Three views of the same example.

Partner A, on her dashboard (/partners/dashboard)

- Her link, with Copy and Share on WhatsApp buttons.
- Clicks, in total and in the last 30 days: 2 in this example.
- Profiles created and how many are paying: 2 and 2.
- Every commission: the business name, the payment, what she earns, and Held, Ready to pay, Paid or Cancelled.
- Payments to her, with the EFT reference. A form to add or change her bank account.
- She signs in with a link we email her, valid once for an hour. No password.

Thabo and Northside Dental

Nothing changes for them. They pay the normal price, never see the partner's commission, and get exactly the same profile and search position as anyone else. The cookie policy names the partner cookie, and it holds only Lindiwe's code.

Us, at /admin/partners

- Applications to approve or decline, with how they plan to promote us.
- Each partner's page: clicks, profiles credited, commission by state, payouts, and their rate. Credit a missed profile by hand, remove a credit, cancel a commission, suspend.
- The payout list, with each partner's bank account, decrypted only on that screen.
- A count of new applications in the admin bar.

SAFEGUARDS

The program can fail.
A customer's payment cannot.

01 PROFILES AND PAYMENTS COME FIRST

Crediting a signup and recording a commission both run after the profile or payment is saved, and swallow their own errors. A partner problem never costs a business its profile or its badge.

02 NO DOUBLE PAYING

One commission per payment, enforced by the database. Payouts are all or nothing: either every Ready commission is marked paid, or none is.

03 NOTHING CLAIMED FROM A FORM

No form can set which partner a profile belongs to. Only the cookie at signup, or an admin, can.

04 PRIVACY

Clicks are daily totals: no IP addresses, no record of who clicked, and link previews are not counted. Bank details are encrypted, and refused rather than stored plain if the encryption key is missing. Terms section 19, privacy section 10 and the cookie policy say all of this.

05 NO ENUMERATION

Applying twice, or asking for a sign in link, gets the same answer whether or not the email belongs to a partner.

06 SPAM RULES

Partners may not spam, add businesses without the owner's agreement, refer their own business, bid on our name in paid search, or promise a higher place in search results. Breaking them can cost unpaid commission.

What this example asks us to decide.

01 THE RATE AND THE MINIMUM

At 20% and R500.00, Partner A with two customers is never paid. Raising the rate or lowering the minimum are settings, not code changes. A fixed bonus on a customer's first payment would need a small code change.

02 WHETHER RENEWALS AFTER 12 MONTHS SHOULD EARN

Today the 13th payment earns nothing. Some programs pay for as long as the customer stays. It is one setting, partners.commissionMonths.

03 HOW WE CHECK PARTNERS

We approve by hand. Decide what makes a yes, and how we spot a partner signing up their own businesses under other emails.

04 REFUNDS AFTER PAYOUT

The system will not reclaim money already paid. Decide whether we take it off the next payout, and say so in the terms.

05 TAX AND RECORDS

Partners are responsible for their own tax. We keep commission and payout records for five years after the last payment. Confirm with the accountant how payouts are booked.

06 THE RELEASE ORDER

Run the migration before the code goes live, or every admin page fails. Production needs the encryption key and the partners:sweep cron line.

IN ONE PARAGRAPH

One link. One credit. Twelve payments.

Partner A's link credits a business that creates its profile on that browser within 60 days. From that business's first payment, she earns 20% of each of its first 12 monthly payments, held 30 days, and paid by EFT once she is owed R500.00. Customer A earns her R72.00; Customer B, who started free and cancelled, earns her R24.00. Free profiles earn nothing, paying never moves a business up, and nothing about the program can cost a customer their profile or their payment.

SETTING (CONFIG\PARTNERS, OR .ENV)	TODAY
partners.commissionRate	20%
partners.commissionMonths	12 payments
partners.holdDays	30 days
partners.minimumPayout	R500.00
partners.cookieDays	60 days
partners.attributionWindowMinutes	60 minutes

WebScheduler (Pty) Ltd · Internal · Rules: app/Services/PartnerService.php · Tests: tests/database/PartnerProgramTest.php